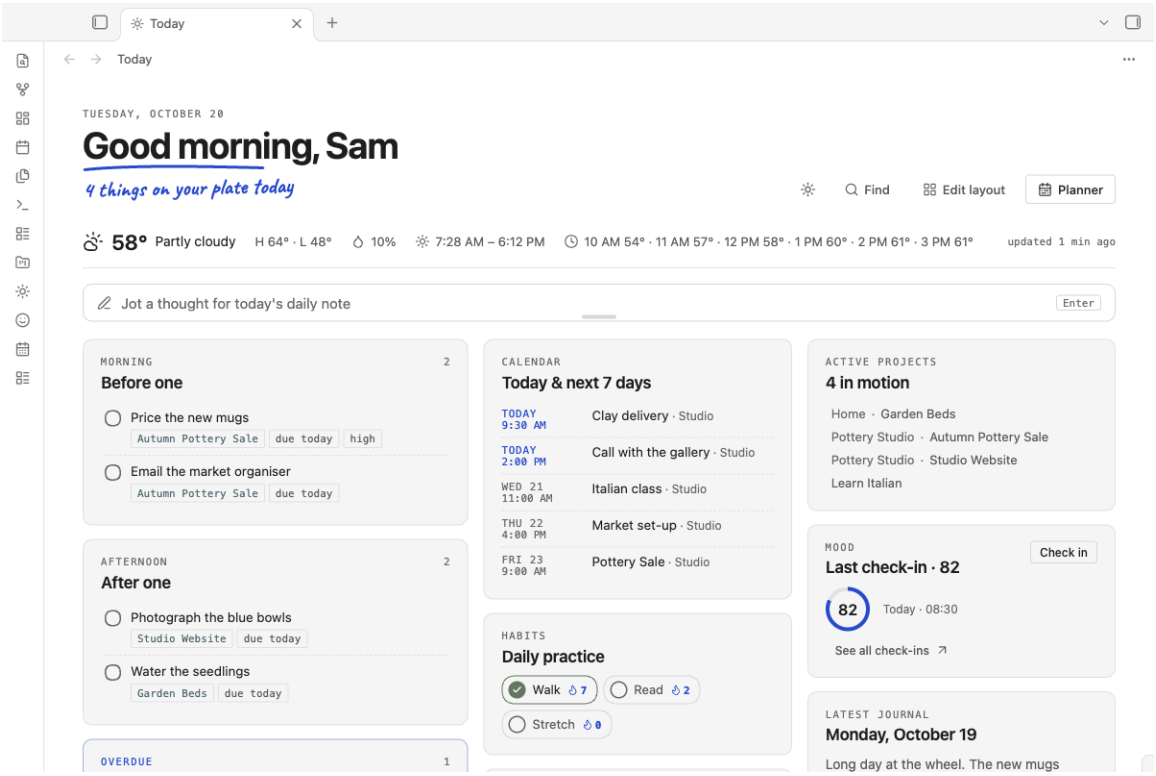
LifeWorld

User manual

LifeWorld turns your vault into a planner: a Today page for the day ahead, a Planner for the day, week and month, a page for every project and area, and a sidebar that keeps it all one click away. Every part can be switched on or off, so you can run only the Today page, only the Planner, or all of it. Tasks stay plain Markdown notes with properties, so you can read, search and edit them like any other note, and they are still there if you turn LifeWorld off.



The parts

Open **Settings → LifeWorld → Parts** and switch on the ones you want. Each works on its own. The task engine runs whenever the Today page, the Planner or Projects is on.

Today page

Your day on one page. Pick the cards you want, drag them where you like with **Edit layout** on the page, and remove the ones you don't use (removing a card only hides it). The cards:

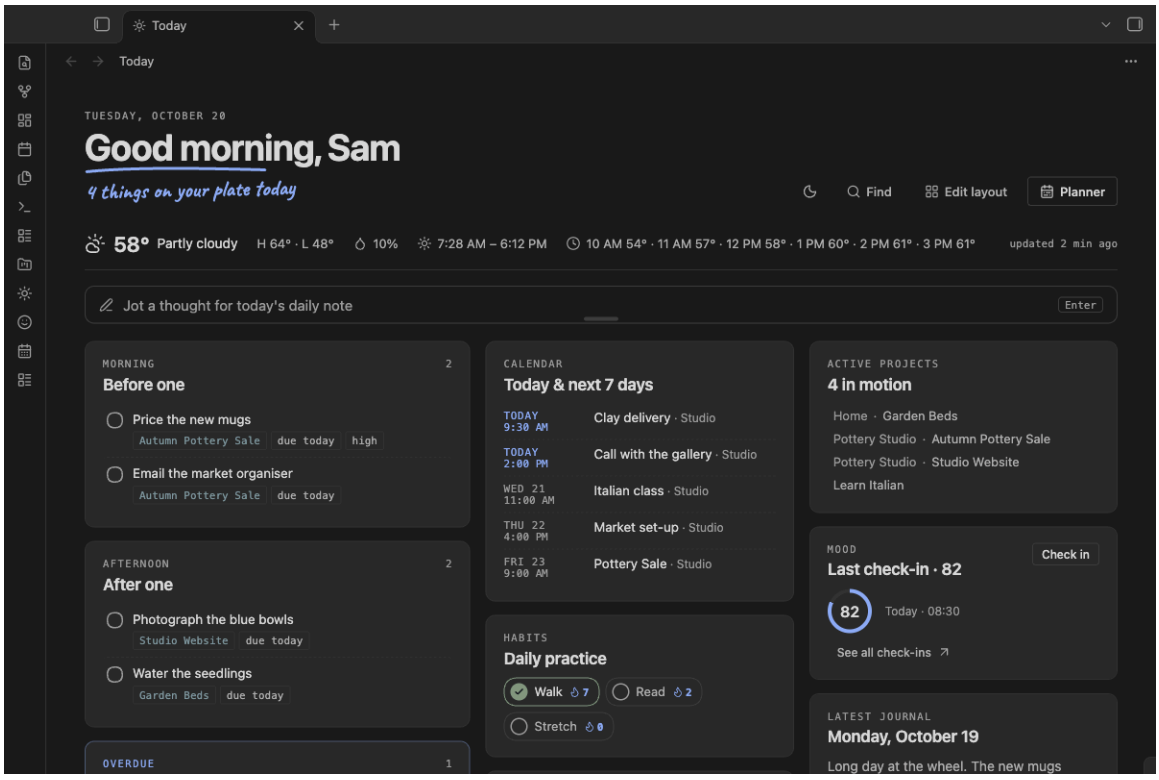
- Weather for your town, the next hours or the next days, and tides if you live by the sea
- Quick capture, which drops a thought into today's daily note
- Morning tasks, afternoon tasks, today's checkbox tasks, and everything overdue
- Calendar: today and the next 7 days, from calendar links you add

- Habits: tick today's habits and watch the streak grow
- Mood: a short check-in and a page that shows how your weeks went
- World clock: your time and any places you add, on a 24-hour sun ring or a classic dial
- Active projects, recent notes, pinned shortcuts
- Latest journal entry, and a journal box that writes a line into today's daily note
- Activity heatmap: a year of active days and your current streak
- News feeds: the newest headlines from feeds you add, off until you turn it on
- A Planner shortcut

For a picture behind the top of the page, choose **Banner scene** in the settings: Mountains, Coast or Volcano. It changes by itself through the day, from dawn to night, using your weather's sunrise and sunset, and the greeting takes its colours from the scene. It is off until you choose one.

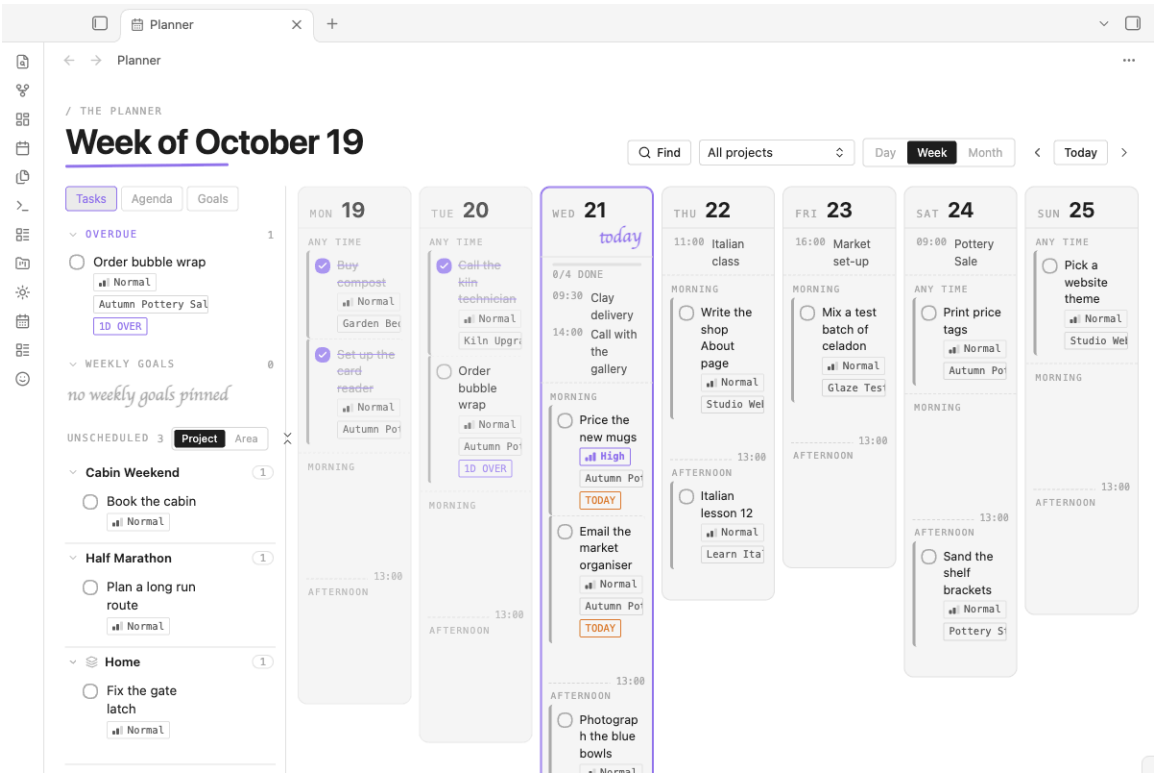
A new install starts with Quick capture, the task cards, Calendar, Recent notes, Mood, Habits and Active projects. The rest are one click away under **Settings → LifeWorld → Today page**.

A task with a reminder and a clock time pops up inside Obsidian while it is open, with Done, In 10 minutes, Open and Dismiss. It starts off: turn it on with **Reminder pop-ups** in the same settings. It works with task notes, and stays off with the TaskNotes plugin, which has its own alerts.



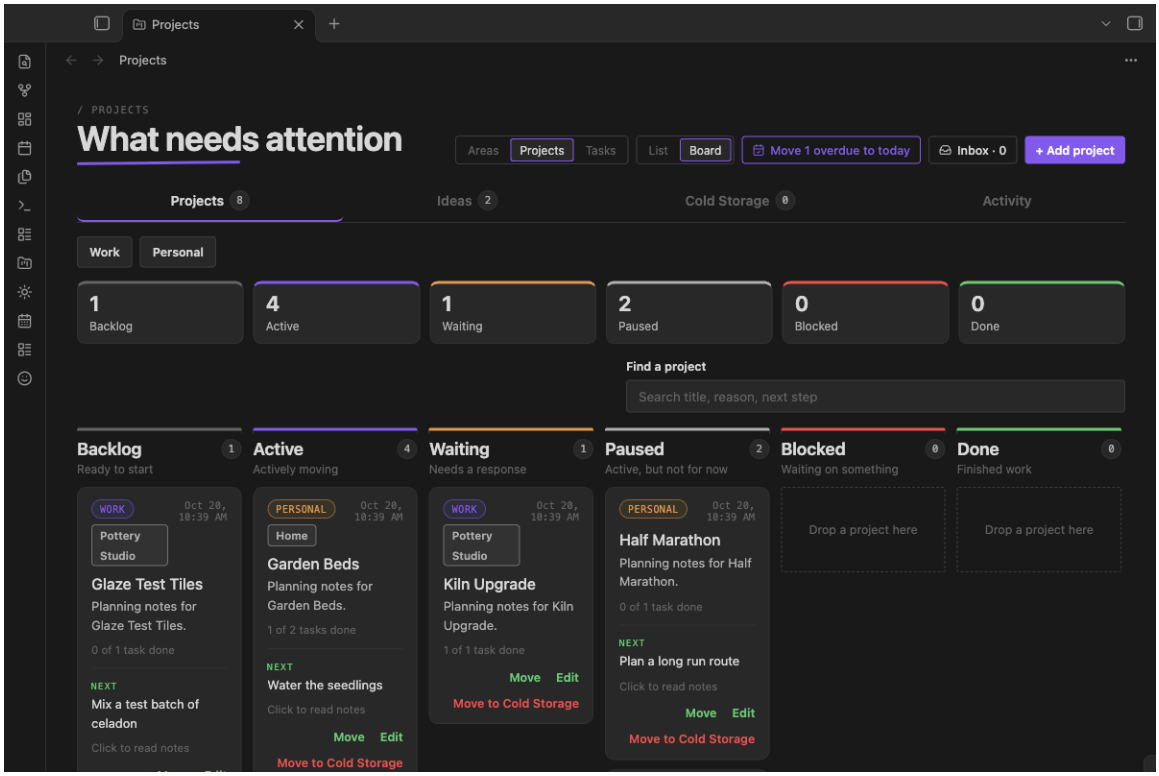
Planner

Your day, week or month as a board. Drag tasks onto a day, then into the morning or the afternoon. Undated tasks wait in a list until you place them, and calendar events show next to your tasks. Placing a task on a day sets its due date, or, if you prefer, only plans it for that day and keeps the due date as it is (**Settings → LifeWorld → Planning**).



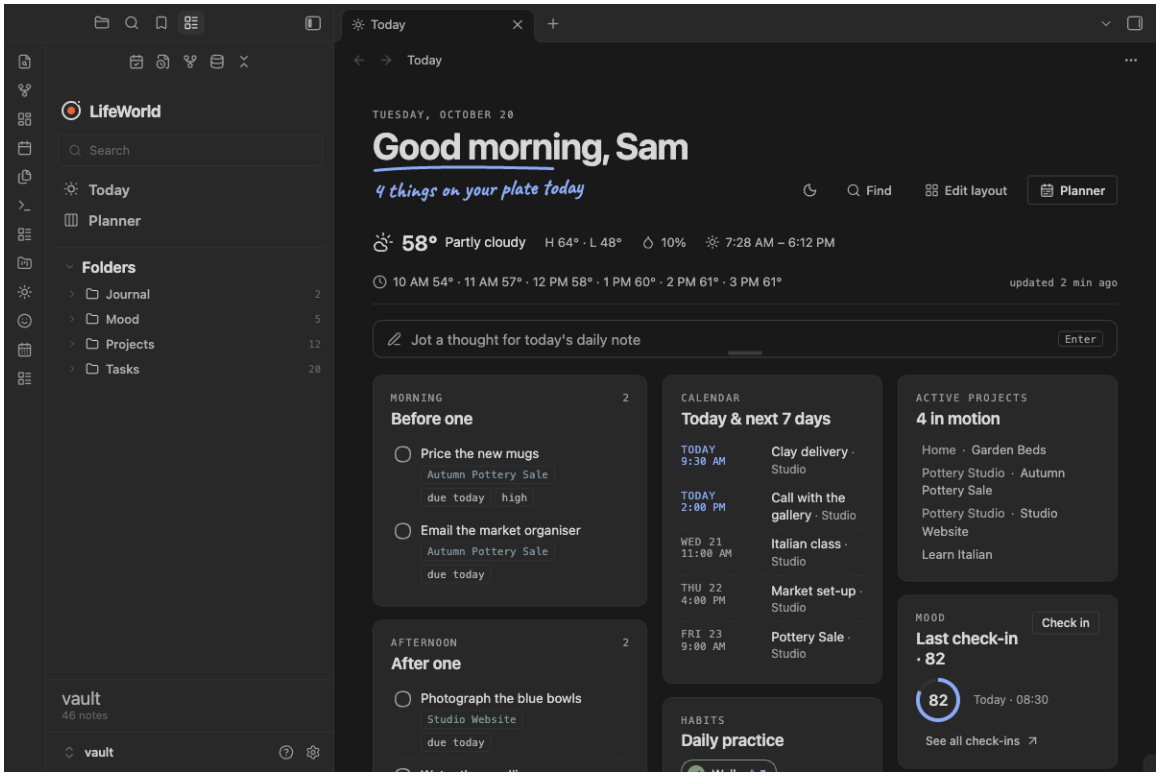
Projects and areas

Your projects, as a list or as a board by status, each with its own page of tasks and notes. The Work and Personal buttons at the top show one side or both. Drag a task by the dots on its left to put a project's list in your own order. Areas hold ongoing work that never finishes, like a studio or your home, with the projects and one-off tasks that belong to it. An Inbox collects tasks with no project or date yet.



Sidebar

A panel on the left with search, Today and the Planner at the top, then your folders with a note count on each. Drag a note onto a folder to move it, and pick how each folder sorts. Turn the Sidebar off and Obsidian's normal file list comes back. Under **Settings → LifeWorld → Sidebar**, **My groups** gathers your folders under names you choose. Your folders and notes stay where they are. Rename or move a folder LifeWorld uses, inside Obsidian, and its settings follow it.



Where your tasks come from

LifeWorld reads one task source at a time (**Settings → LifeWorld → Tasks**):

- **LifeWorld's own task notes**: one note per task, in the TaskNotes format. If the TaskNotes plugin is installed, you can let it do the writing instead.
- **Checkboxes** in any note, including the Tasks plugin's date and priority signs.
- **Todoist** or **ClickUp**, with your own API token.
- **Things 3**, on a Mac only.

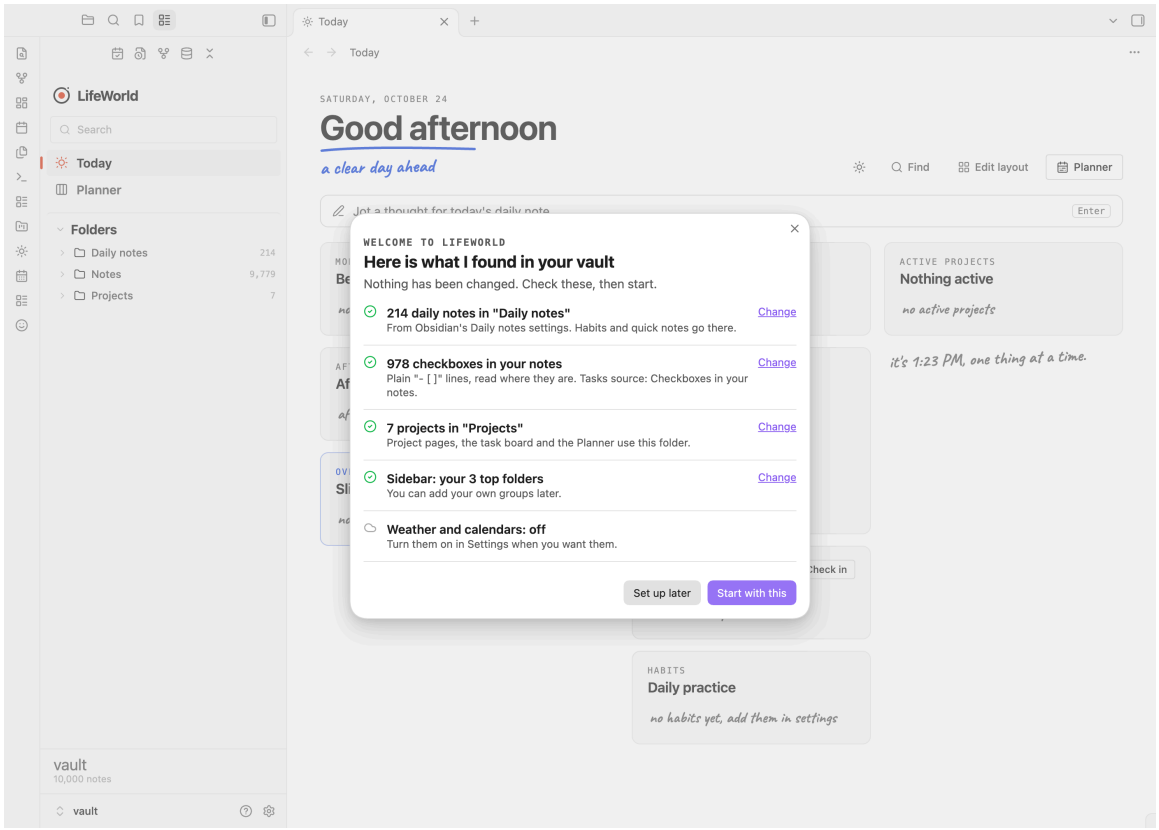
Add a task by typing a sentence like `call Max friday 3pm !high`; LifeWorld picks out the day, the time and the priority. Tasks can repeat, wait on other tasks, and move to an archive folder when they are done. One button moves everything overdue to today, with Undo.

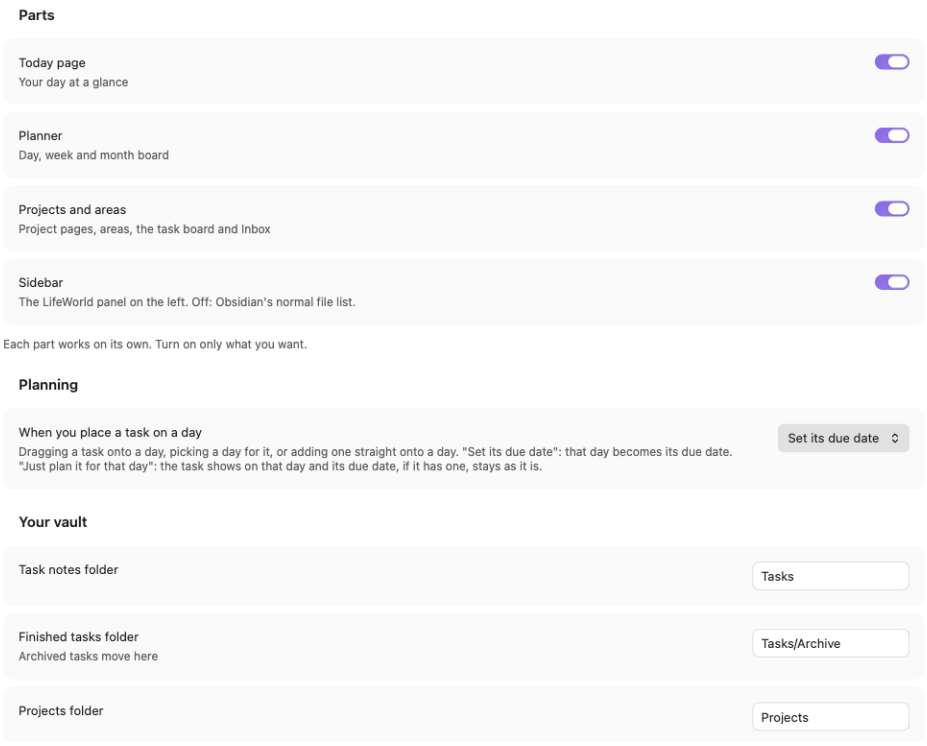
Getting started

1. In Obsidian, open **Settings → Community plugins → Browse**, search for "LifeWorld", select **Install**, then **Enable**.
2. The first time LifeWorld starts, a welcome window shows what it found in your vault: your daily notes, your tasks (task notes or checkboxes), your projects folder and your top folders. Nothing is changed until you select **Start with this**, which sets LifeWorld up with what it found. **Set up later** or the X closes it without changing anything, and it does not open by itself again. To see it again, open **Settings → LifeWorld → Your vault** and select **Run setup**.

3. Open **Settings → LifeWorld**. Under **Parts**, switch on the parts you want.
4. Under **Your vault**, check the folders. A new install uses `Tasks` (finished ones in `Tasks/Archive`), `Projects`, `Goals`, `Habits`, `Journal` and `Mood`, and your settings from Obsidian's Daily notes plugin. Point them at your own folders if you already have them. The names of the task properties can be changed there too.
5. Select the sun icon in the ribbon to open the Today page, or run **LifeWorld: Open today** from the command palette.

LifeWorld works on Obsidian for desktop, iPhone, iPad and Android. Things 3 is offered only on a Mac.





Your data and the network

There is no account, no payment and no tracking of any kind. LifeWorld reads and writes notes inside your vault and keeps its settings in its own plugin folder. API tokens, the Stormglass key and calendar links are kept on each device in Obsidian's local storage, never in the settings file or a note, so Obsidian Sync and git backups do not carry them.

LifeWorld connects to the internet only for features you switch on:

Feature	Service	What is sent
Weather on the Today page	Open-Meteo forecast (`api.open-meteo.com`), free, no account	The latitude and longitude of the town you picked
Tides (part of Weather)	Open-Meteo marine (`marine-api.open-meteo.com`), or Stormglass (`api.stormglass.io`) with your own key, at most once a day	The same latitude and longitude
Town search (Weather) and place search (World clock)	Open-Meteo geocoding (`geocoding-api.open-meteo.com`)	The letters you type, from 3 letters on
Calendar	The calendar links you add (Google, Apple, Outlook or any ICS address)	A request to each link, every 30 minutes
News feeds	The feed sites you add	A request to each feed, when the Today page opens and at most once an hour
Todoist tasks	Todoist (`api.todoist.com`) with your token	Your token; reads your tasks and writes the changes you make
ClickUp tasks	ClickUp (`api.clickup.com`) with your token	Your token; reads your tasks and writes the changes you make

With these off, LifeWorld makes no network requests. If you pick Things 3 (macOS desktop only), LifeWorld reads and updates your Things to-dos by running Things' own AppleScript, because Things offers no other way to read them. macOS asks you to allow it once, and nothing goes online. This is the only reason LifeWorld runs an outside command.

Support

Found a bug or have an idea? Please open an issue. I read every one.

LifeWorld is free. If it helps you and you would like to say thanks, you can buy me a coffee.

Licence

MIT, see LICENSE. LifeWorld also bundles ical.js (Mozilla Public License 2.0, unmodified) and four handwriting fonts under the SIL Open Font License; their notices are in THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md and at the end of `main.js`.

Built on TaskNotes. LifeWorld's task engine contains code ported from TaskNotes and @tasknotes/model by Callum Alpass (MIT License), and it reads and writes task notes in the same format, so both plugins can work on the same notes. Thank you, Callum. Full notice: THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md.